EXPERIMENT 9

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

EcoCycle – E-Waste Collection & Recycling Management

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1. Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account, to explore the platform interface and its architecture, and to create the EcoCycle application on which the rest of the experiments are carried out.

2. Architecture Diagram

Figure 9.1 shows the layers of the EcoCycle application on the Zoho Creator platform.

USERS & ACCESS	Application user, requester and recycler through a web browser (desktop, tablet and mobile views)
PRESENTATION	Menu: E-waste Entries, App Preferences, Collection Requests, Recycling Tracking, EcoCycle Dashboard, AI Agents. Forms: E-Waste Entry, Collection Request, Recycling Tracking. Reports: All E-Waste, High Priority E-Waste, Collection Requests, Recycling Tracking Report. Dashboard: priority pie chart, two status bar charts, three embedded reports
LOGIC (DELUGE)	Priority score and level • initial statuses • past-date check • high-priority e-mail • CRM lead creation
INTEGRATIONS	Zoho CRM connection (Leads) • EcoCycle Data Assistant (Zia chat agent, read-only) • Custom API: EcoCycle Summary API (GET, OAuth2)
DATA LAYER	Forms as tables: E_Waste_Entry, Collection_Request, Recycling_Tracking in Creator's cloud database
ZOHO CLOUD PLATFORM	Hosting, authentication and storage (India data centre)

Figure 9.1: Architecture of the EcoCycle application on Zoho Creator

Architecture flow

1. The user opens EcoCycle in a browser and enters data through the forms.
2. The data is stored in the Creator database and the Deluge workflows apply the business rules.
3. Workflows send the e-mail alert and create a lead in Zoho CRM.
4. Reports, the dashboard and the chat agent show the position to the user.

3. Procedure

Step 1: Opening Zoho Creator and signing in

1. Open the Zoho Creator website and review the landing page (Platform, Features, Pricing, Solutions, Sign In).

2. Click **Sign In**. Enter the e-mail address of the Zoho account, or choose a social sign-in, and select **Next**. New users select **Sign up now**.



Figure 9.2: Zoho Creator landing page



Figure 9.3: Sign in / authentication page

Step 2: Exploring the Creator dashboard

After signing in, the dashboard lists the applications of the workspace. The left sidebar is grouped into **Develop** (Applications, Microservices), **Deploy** (Environments, Mobile, Portal) and **Manage** (Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, Billing). The trial banner (Trial expires in 13 days) with the Upgrade button is shown in the header.

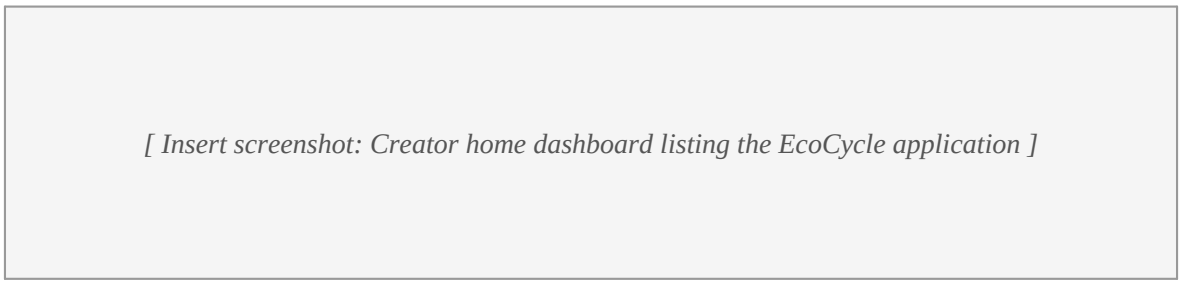


Figure 9.4: Creator dashboard with the sidebar

Step 3: Creating the EcoCycle application

1. Click **Create Application**. The options offered are Create using Zia (GenAI), Create from scratch, Create from gallery and Import from file.
2. Select **Create from scratch**, enter the application name **EcoCycle** (link name **ecocycle**) and create it.
3. Add the three forms E-Waste Entry, Collection Request and Recycling Tracking with the fields listed in the project report, and add the reports and the dashboard page.

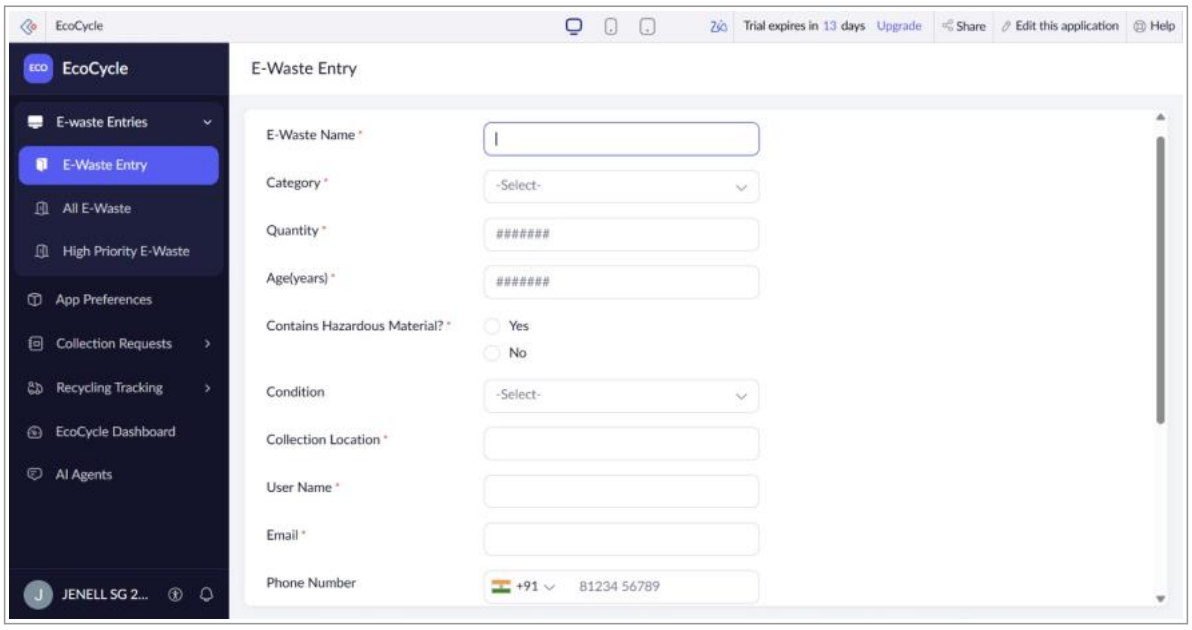


Figure 9.5: E-Waste Entry form of the EcoCycle application in access mode

Step 4: Exploring Microservices

Open **Microservices** from the Develop section. The tabs All Services, AI Models, AR Library, Connections, Datasources and Custom API hold the integrations of the application. EcoCycle uses one connection (Zoho CRM) and one Custom API.

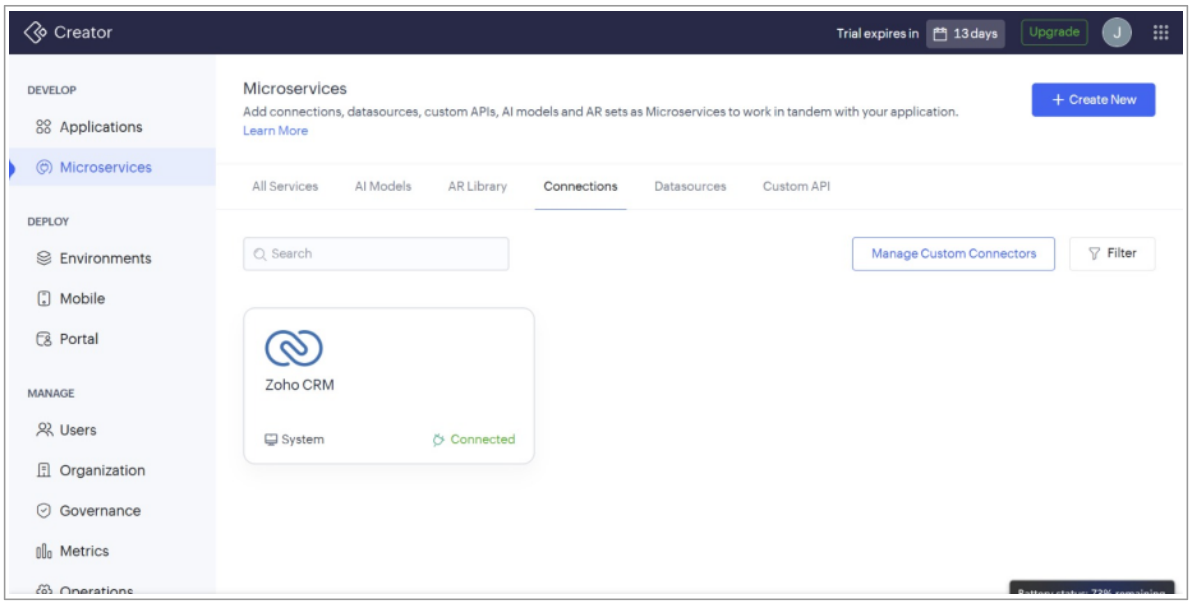


Figure 9.6: Microservices → Connections showing the Zoho CRM connection

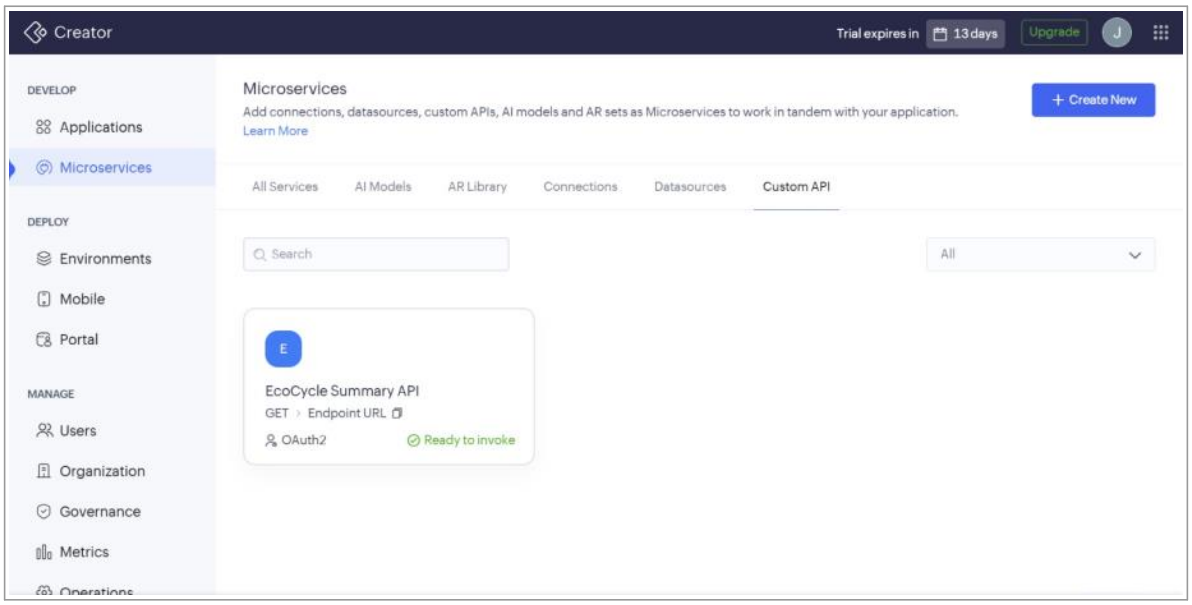


Figure 9.7: Microservices → Custom API showing the EcoCycle Summary API (GET, OAuth2, Ready to invoke)

Step 5: Opening the live application

Open EcoCycle in access mode. The sidebar lists the six menu items and the header shows Share, Edit this application and the desktop, tablet and mobile views.

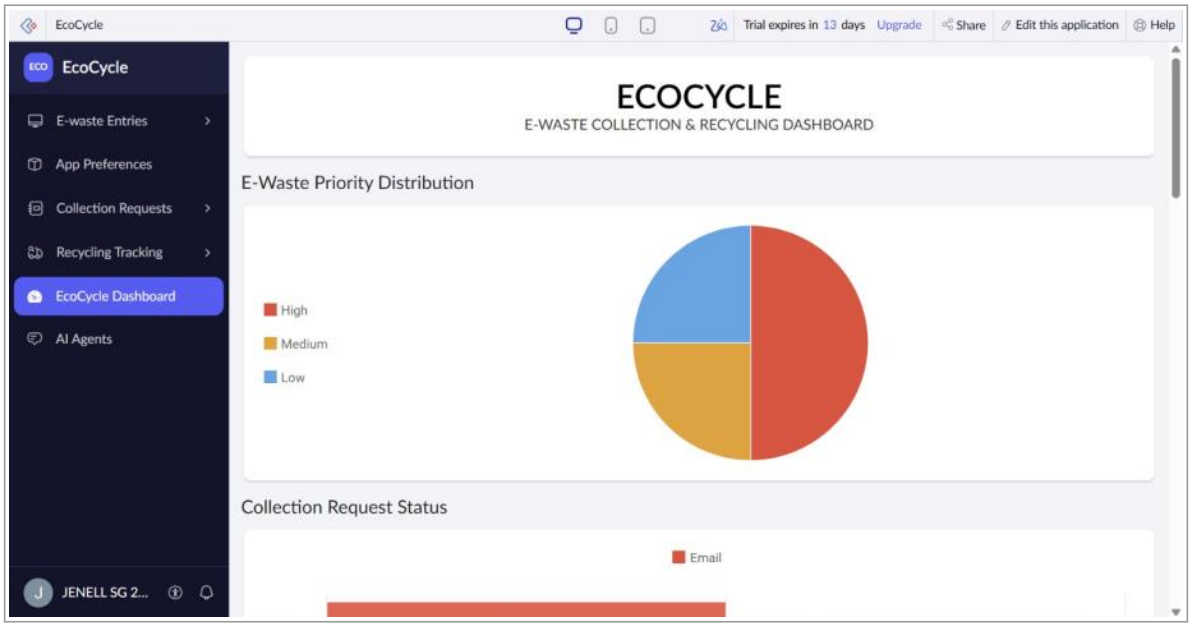


Figure 9.8: EcoCycle Dashboard in access mode

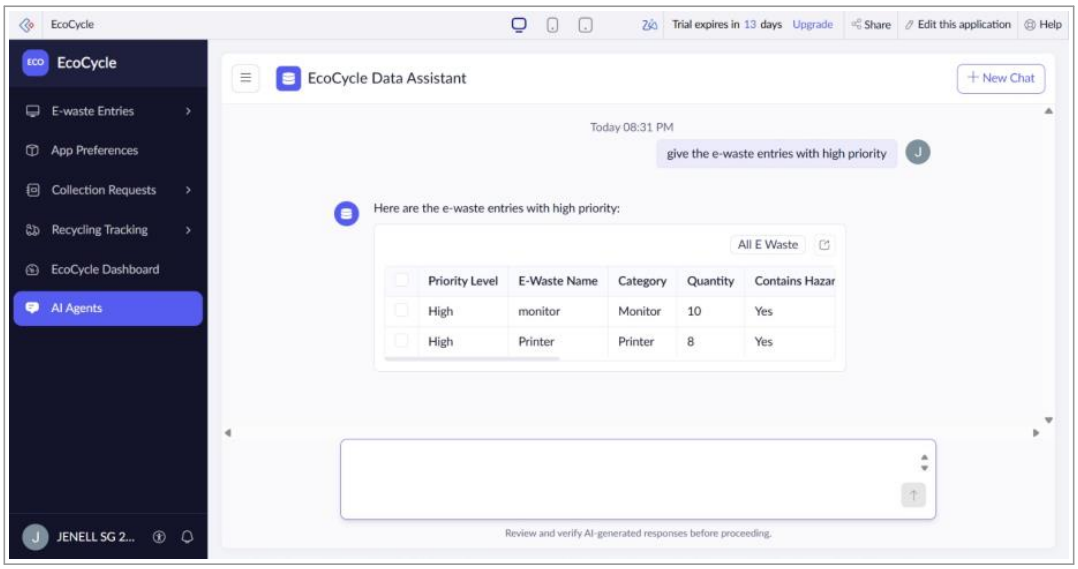


Figure 9.9: AI Agents page — EcoCycle Data Assistant answering a high-priority question

4. Observations

Item	Value Observed
Application name / link name	EcoCycle / ecocycle
Creator data centre	India (creatorapp.zoho.in)
Plan	Trial edition (13 days remaining when the screenshots were taken)
Forms / reports	3 forms; 4 reports; 1 dashboard page; 1 AI Agents page
Integrations	Zoho CRM connection (Connected); Zia chat agent; Custom API EcoCycle Summary API (OAuth2)
Roles / environments	Owner account only; single application instance (no stage or production publish)

5. Result

A Zoho Creator account was set up, the platform interface (Develop, Deploy and Manage sections, Microservices and the application access mode) was explored, and the EcoCycle application was created with its forms, reports, dashboard and integrations.

6. Conclusion

The experiment introduced the architecture of Zoho Creator: forms form the data layer, Deluge forms the logic layer, and reports, pages and the menu form the presentation layer, with integrations, security and deployment handled by the platform. Understanding these layers made it possible to build EcoCycle without a separate server. The trial plan limits how long the application stays available, so it should be upgraded or moved before the trial ends.